GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Mines

Unlocking Resources, Building the Future

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August 2026

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HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

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HONORABLE MINISTER,

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DIRECTOR GENERAL, CHAMBER OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRIES OF INDIA

MESSAGE

India's mineral resources constitute a strategic national asset that supports industrial development, infrastructure creation, manufacturing, energy security, and economic growth. The Ministry of Mines plays a pivotal role in ensuring the scientific exploration, sustainable extraction, efficient utilization, and responsible management of the country's mineral wealth while promoting transparency, technological advancement, and environmental stewardship.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) recognizes that a modern and sustainable mining sector is fundamental to India's vision of becoming a globally competitive manufacturing and industrial economy. Through policy advocacy, investment facilitation, technology partnerships, industry collaboration, startup promotion, skill development, and innovation-led initiatives, CCI India remains committed to supporting the Ministry's efforts in strengthening India's mining ecosystem.

This Knowledge Paper provides comprehensive insights into the Ministry's strategic priorities, policy reforms, institutional framework, investment landscape, and emerging opportunities across mineral exploration, critical minerals, sustainable mining practices, mine digitization, value addition, processing technologies, logistics, and environmental management. It also highlights collaborative pathways where government, industry, academia, and technology providers can work together to enhance productivity and global competitiveness.

The publication serves as a valuable resource for policymakers, mining companies, investors, technology providers, research institutions, academic organizations, financial institutions, and development partners seeking to contribute to the growth of India's mining sector. Through informed dialogue and strategic collaboration, it aims to encourage responsible mining, attract investments, promote innovation, and strengthen industrial development.

As India moves towards greater economic self-reliance and industrial excellence, the mining sector will continue to play a defining role in supporting national growth. CCI India remains committed to partnering with the Ministry of Mines in building a sustainable, technologically advanced, and globally competitive mining ecosystem.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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Preface

Few sectors sit as quietly at the foundation of national capability as mining and minerals, and few are as consequential to the decade ahead. The Ministry of Mines, Government of India, carries the constitutional and institutional mandate to convert the nation's geological endowment its iron ore, bauxite, copper, manganese, limestone and an expanding basket of critical and strategic minerals into the raw material security on which steel, aluminium, electronics, clean energy, defence and advanced manufacturing all depend. As India's growth trajectory accelerates and global supply chains for critical minerals become an instrument of geopolitical leverage, the Ministry's role has moved from a regulatory back-office function to a front-line determinant of India's industrial and strategic autonomy.

The national development context could not be more pointed. The Government has committed an outlay of approximately ₹34,300 crore over seven years to the National Critical Mineral Mission, auctioned a record 212 mineral blocks in a single financial year, and amended the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act twice within five years to accelerate exploration and reduce regulatory friction. Yet India still explores only a fraction of its prospective geological terrain, imports a disproportionate share of the minerals that will power its energy transition, and converts auctioned blocks into producing mines more slowly than the ambition of Viksit Bharat 2047 demands. The distance between policy intent and ground-level execution is precisely where institutional partnership bridging government, industry, investors, states and innovators creates the greatest value.

This Knowledge Paper has been prepared with a single purpose: to present an analytically grounded, evidence-based assessment of the Ministry of Mines' mandate, progress and emerging priorities, and to identify where CCI India can meaningfully contribute as an implementation partner rather than a passive observer. The paper is deliberately structured in the manner of a strategic advisory document combining sectoral analysis, benchmarking, gap assessment and actionable programme design so that it may inform real decisions rather than merely describe the status quo.

CCI India's vision in commissioning this paper is to position itself as a credible, execution-oriented bridge between the Ministry's policy architecture and the industry, investor, startup and academic ecosystems it ultimately depends upon for delivery. CCI India does not seek to substitute for government; it seeks to absorb the coordination, outreach and capacity-building tasks that lie beyond the bandwidth of any ministry, and to do so with the national network, institutional credibility and execution experience that a multi-decade chamber body can bring.

Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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1. Introduction to the Ministry

The Ministry of Mines occupies a distinctive constitutional position within India's federal architecture. Mineral regulation and development is formally listed under Entry 23 of the State List in the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution, vesting primary ownership and revenue rights in state governments. However, Entry 54 of the Union List empowers Parliament to legislate on the "regulation of mines and mineral development to the extent that such regulation is declared by Parliament to be expedient in the public interest." This single constitutional provision is the foundation of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 the principal legislation through which the Union Government has, since 1957, retained overriding authority over mineral concessions, royalty structures and conservation standards while states continue to grant leases, collect royalties and administer day-to-day mining operations within their boundaries.

Ministry Mandate

The Ministry of Mines is the nodal Union Ministry responsible for survey and exploration of all minerals other than coal, lignite, petroleum, natural gas and atomic minerals; for the mining and metallurgy of non-ferrous metals such as aluminium, copper, zinc, lead, gold and nickel; and for the formulation, administration and amendment of the legal and policy framework governing exploration, mining leases, mineral conservation and auction-based allocation. This mandate has expanded materially in recent years to include the strategic stewardship of critical and rare earth minerals, overseas mineral asset acquisition through joint-venture vehicles, and the coordination of a whole-of-government critical minerals mission that draws in the Ministries of Steel, Coal, Commerce, External Affairs, Science & Technology and Environment.

Evolution of the Mandate

The Ministry's functional emphasis has shifted three times since Independence. Between 1957 and 1993, the regime was administratively discretionary, oriented towards public-sector resource mobilisation under the Industrial Policy Resolution framework. The National Mineral Policy of 1993 opened the sector to private and foreign investment in exploration and mining following the broader liberalisation of the Indian economy. The most consequential transition began with the 2015 amendment to the MMDR Act, which replaced discretionary allocation with competitive electronic auctions, introduced the National Mineral Exploration Trust (NMET) to fund regional exploration, and created District Mineral Foundations (DMFs) to channel a share of mining revenue back to affected communities. The Ministry today is consolidating a fourth phase: the shift from a volume-and-revenue orientation towards a strategic-autonomy orientation, in which critical mineral self-sufficiency, supply chain security and downstream value addition are treated as matters of national strategic priority rather than purely commercial regulation.

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